

WARNING: Do These 4 Things Before 2026 Ends

Channel: Brandon Carter · Published: Sep 25, 2026 · Watch: https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=_D7hfnaIR7w Source: full transcript

Executive Summary

Brandon Carter, who has coached 15,000+ people and built 7- and 8-figure businesses, compresses decades of self-improvement knowledge into 4 foundational actions that he says make failure nearly impossible when practiced consistently.

Contents

-  Step 1: Fix Your Body Chemistry — Track Everything for 14 Days
-  Step 2: Track Your Mood to Raise Your Baseline
-  Supplements, Peptides, and Medications Brandon Uses
-  Step 3: Schedule Every Hour of Every Day on Your Calendar
-  You Have More Time Than You Think — The Math
-  Step 4: Design Your Life by Default (Friction Engineering)
-  Case Study: Jen Caesar — Full-Time Nurse to \$500K in Year One
-  Recap and Final Takeaways

Step 1: Fix Your Body Chemistry — Track Everything for 14 Days 1:03

- The core premise: everything you achieve in life is done through your body, so it must be in peak condition first
 - Applying productivity hacks, biohacking, or peptides to a broken body is like "pouring water into a leaky bucket"
 - You must find your baseline before you can optimize
- **Track all of the following every day for 14 days:**
 - Sleep — quantity AND quality (not just hours)
 - Supplements and caffeine intake
 - Calories and macros (not just food types — actual numbers)
 - Training sessions
 - Daily step count
 - Mood and focus levels
- Recommended tools for sleep and calorie tracking:
 - Apple Watch or WHOOP for sleep tracking

- Brandon personally uses an **Oura Ring** because he doesn't always wear his Apple Watch; it syncs with Apple Health and tracks calories burned plus sleep quality
- Recommended method for calorie/macro logging:
 - Use **Claude** or **ChatGPT** — both now integrate with Apple Health
 - Brandon takes a photo of food or verbally describes what he ate (e.g., "two eggs, skinless chicken thigh, a chicken leg, 5 oz sugar-free honey mustard") and the AI computes a running daily total
 - At end of day he tells the AI how many calories his Oura Ring says he burned; the AI outputs his surplus or deficit and compares against his protein goal
 - He has been doing this in a single ongoing chat since September — the chat acts as a live nutrition log
 - Free tool available in description: **Victory Vision Planner** (a Notion template) — syncs with the Claude/ChatGPT prompt so all data flows into one database
- What to do with the 14 days of data:
 - Identify patterns that are hurting your metrics (poor sleep, low protein, bad mood days)
 - Fix those leaks before adding any optimization on top
- Brandon's personal protein targets referenced as an example: aims for 200+ g/day, tries to stay under 300 g; water intake was one area he discovered he was consistently under-performing

😊 Step 2: Track Your Mood to Raise Your Baseline 6:59

- Brandon discovered mood tracking in 2006–2007 after being diagnosed with **Bipolar 2 disorder** — he never needed medication because of this practice
- **How to track mood (the original manual method):**
 - Draw a small graph: Y-axis = mood (1–10 scale), X-axis = time of day (e.g., 6am, 8am, 10am, 12pm, 2pm...)
 - Set an alarm every 2 hours; ask yourself "1–10, how do I feel right now?" and plot the point
 - At day's end, connect the dots to see your curve and calculate your daily average
- **The core insight:** your average mood score across many days IS your personality — it determines the quality of everything you do
 - A sales call made in a bad mood produces worse results than the same call in a great mood
 - Studying while excited yields better retention than studying while angry
 - Even parenting quality degrades when you're in a low-mood state
- Once you have 14 days of mood data alongside your physiological data:
 - Identify **mood killers** (things consistently correlated with low scores) — for Brandon, being late to tasks was a major one
 - Identify **mood boosters** (things correlated with high scores) — e.g., post-workout states, earning money
 - **Eliminate or reduce the negatives** — Brandon credits data-backed evidence for helping him exit relationships that were dragging his average down

- **Do more of the positives** — but only healthy ones; harmful "highs" (drugs, risky behavior) create dependency not genuine elevation
- As your average mood rises above a 7, Brandon says alcohol and cannabis start to feel like they are lowering you rather than lifting you — the craving naturally diminishes
- App recommendation: **I Mood Journal** — \$2 one-time purchase, no subscription; Brandon has no sponsorship deal with them
 - A friend used it and quit cannabis entirely because the data showed it wasn't actually getting him to a "10" — more like a 7 or 8, and once his baseline rose above that, cannabis felt like a step down

Supplements, Peptides, and Medications Brandon Uses 13:40

- Framing caveat repeated multiple times: **"Talk to your doctor before doing any of this."** These are tools, not magic; they only work on a solid foundation of tracked nutrition and sleep
- **Supplements for fitness goals:**
 - Creatine, protein, caffeine — standard and evidence-backed
 - **Creatine dose:** Brandon takes **20 g/day** (muscle-building requires only 5 g, but higher doses show cognitive function benefits in research)
 - Peptides as optional additions
- **Brandon's personal stack (started near age 40):**
 - **Testosterone** — began because levels had dropped due to aging (natural decline starts at 30 for all men)
 - **Tirzepatide** — peptide
 - **BPC-157** — peptide
 - **MK-677 (Ipamorelin) / Tesamorelin** — for energy and to increase natural growth hormone
 - **Adderall** — has a prescription; uses sparingly, only when something critical needs to get done; notes it is habit-forming
 - **Modafinil** — has a prescription; uses for extremely demanding cognitive work; also habit-forming, so reserved for "emergencies"
 - **Cialis (tadalafil)** — has taken daily for ~15 years; uses it as a vasodilator for circulation, muscle building (cites multiple studies), and potential longevity benefits — NOT primarily for erectile dysfunction
- Key principle: "If you're not tracking calories and macros and your sleep isn't right, all the supplements in the world won't help you. Fix the bucket first."

Step 3: Schedule Every Hour of Every Day on Your Calendar 17:10

- Brandon calls this **"the #1 strategy I can give you to improve your life"** — he has used it for 27+ years
- Quote he references: **Bruce Lee — "If you love life, don't waste time, for time is what life is made of."**
- The mechanism: when every hour is assigned a purpose, bad habits are automatically crowded out — you won't schedule "smoke weed while playing Call of Duty" on your calendar

- Brandon's own sobriety from cannabis and alcohol was an accident of this system — he looked up one day and realized he hadn't used either in months because there was simply no unscheduled time for it
- **How to build your calendar using AI (Gemini recommended for Google Calendar):**
 - Open **Gemini** (free account works) — it's the only AI that natively syncs with Google Calendar; Google Calendar also syncs with Apple Calendar
 - Tell Gemini your recurring commitments in natural language, e.g.:
 - "I sleep every night 10pm–6am. Add this as a recurring event starting today."
 - "I work Monday–Friday 9am–5pm. Add as recurring."
 - "I work out every day at 7am for one hour. Also add a 30-min block before for getting ready, and a block after for showering before work."
 - Gemini creates the events instantly; Brandon demonstrates this live in the video
 - Fill every remaining white space with goal-directed blocks
 - Also schedule enjoyable things: date night, family time, entertainment — put it all in so nothing gets crowded out unintentionally
- Practical color-coding tip: mark date nights in pink every Friday as a recurring event
- The calendar doubles as an anti-bad-habit system: you won't have unstructured time to fall into scrolling, binging, or other time-wasting behaviors



You Have More Time Than You Think — The Math [18:32](#)

- Brandon walks through a weekly time audit to silence the "I don't have time" objection:

Activity	Hours/Week
Sleep (8 hrs/night)	56
Work (full-time)	40
Commute (if applicable)	10+
Exercise (7 days/week, 1 hr)	7
Family time (2× average man)	14
Total accounted for	~127
Remaining out of 168	~41

- Even with generous allocations for every major life category, most people have **40+ hours per week unaccounted for**
- The problem isn't lack of time — it's lack of structure for that time
- People who say "family is the most important thing" but can't state how many hours they spend with family per week are, in Brandon's words, "just talking"

Step 4: Design Your Life by Default (Friction Engineering) 25:10

- Core concept: **friction** — manipulate how easy or hard different choices are so you don't need willpower
 - **Increase friction** on things you want to do less
 - **Decrease friction** on things you want to do more
- Examples of **increasing friction on bad habits**:
 - When working, Brandon puts his phone in the bathroom charger in another room — now checking social media requires getting up and walking; the barrier makes it easy to say no
 - Delete distracting apps from your phone entirely
 - Keep a separate phone for social media only (Brandon used to do this — social media phone had no contacts, his regular phone had no social apps)
 - Move all social media apps to an iPad (preferably Wi-Fi only, no LTE) — social media apps are poorly optimized for iPad, making them naturally less addictive
 - Don't keep tempting food in the house — Brandon has no ice cream at home; getting it requires going out, getting recognized, taking photos with fans, etc. — too much friction
- Examples of **decreasing friction on good habits**:
 - Brandon's new morning deep-work routine: the night before, he premixes his pre-workout (300 mg caffeine) and leaves it on the desk; puts his glasses there too; leaves his phone in his robe pocket across the bedroom so the alarm forces him to get up and walk 20 yards
 - By the time he walks to the desk, uses the bathroom, and drinks the pre-workout, he is working within 5 minutes of waking — no decision-making required
 - Key principle: eliminate the gap between waking and starting the desired behavior
- **Case study within this section**: Jen Caesar (see below) slept in her workout clothes so she could start exercising the moment she woke up — zero friction between waking and working out

Case Study: Jen Caesar — Full-Time Nurse to \$500K in Year One 29:41

- Jen joined Brandon's program **High Ticket Trainer (HTT/HTP)** while working as a full-time nurse with two young kids and a husband
- Her friction-reduction hack: **slept in her workout clothes** so she could start exercising immediately upon waking with no barrier
- Results from applying Brandon's systems:
 - First month as an online trainer: **\$20,000**
 - In November (a month she only worked 2 weeks): **\$48,000**
 - First full year in the program: **\$500,000 (half a million dollars)**
- During this entire period she maintained: full-time job (40 hours/week), proper sleep, daily exercise, healthy eating, multiple week-long vacations with her husband
- She had only a few thousand followers when she started — not a large audience prerequisite

- Her quote: "I don't want to hear you don't have time. I don't want to hear you're too tired. I don't want to hear you don't know what you're doing. I was doing a 40-hour full-time job and posting every day. Nobody has an excuse."

✓ Recap and Final Takeaways [33:57](#)

- Brandon's summary of the 4 things to do before 2026 ends:
 - **Track all inputs** — sleep, food, macros, calories, steps, supplements, training, mood, focus — for at least 14 days to fix your physiological baseline
 - **Monitor your mood** every 2 hours, calculate your daily average, eliminate what lowers it, repeat what raises it — your average mood is your personality and determines the quality of all your output
 - **Schedule every single hour of every day** on Google Calendar using Gemini AI to build recurring blocks; fill white space deliberately with goal-directed work; this alone eliminates most bad habits passively
 - **Engineer friction** — make bad behaviors harder to access, make good behaviors the path of least resistance; design your environment so discipline is rarely required

"If you do just these four things from now until the end of the year, it will be hard to fail at your goals — whatever they are."

- Free resources mentioned:
 - **Victory Vision Planner** (Notion template) — in video description
 - AI prompt for calorie/macro tracking — in video description
 - Free live training on growing an online fitness business with AI — link in description
 - Follow-up video on goal planning also linked at end of video